Acid-Base with ROME

Fundamentals | Fluid, Electrolytes, and Acid-Base Balance

REMEMBER IT AS

Respiratory Opposite, Metabolic Equal

- **Respiratory acidosis**
  pH low, PaCO2 high: hypoventilation, COPD, opioid overdose.
- **Respiratory alkalosis**
  pH high, PaCO2 low: hyperventilation, anxiety, early sepsis.
- **Metabolic acidosis / alkalosis**
  pH and HCO3 move together: DKA and diarrhea (acidosis), vomiting and NG suction (alkalosis).

NURSE TIP

Kussmaul respirations are the body blowing off CO2 to correct metabolic acidosis.